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## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Summit Classical Academy  
School Website: <https://summitclassicalacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

**ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Summit Classical Academy (SCA) presents a cohesive, well-articulated Classical Christian program anchored in a biblically-informed worldview. Across the six classical criteria, SCA demonstrates clear Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, a purposeful and virtue-first aim, a Trivium-based Curriculum with Great Books engagement, a pedagogy that blends Socratic inquiry with rhetoric, a faculty culture described as mentors living the curriculum, and an active partnership with parents and the broader community. The public materials consistently emphasize God, Christ, virtue, truth, formation, and engagement with Great Books, along with explicit statements about partnering with families and involving parents as co-educators. The aggregate assessment across all six categories is **CLASSICAL**.

Key higher-signal indicators include: explicit Christ-centered messaging and biblical worldview; formation of character and virtue as core aims; Trivium-based curriculum with Great Books and a focus on philosophical and historical thought; upper-school emphasis on Socratic dialogue, seminars, and rhetoric; a living-faculty/mentorship model and ACCS accreditation; and documented partnerships with parents and a strong parent/community orientation. There is consistent use of terms such as truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; formation; Great Books; Trivium; Socratic dialogue; public affirmation of parental partnership; and explicit theological framing.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school explicitly frames itself as a "private school grounded in a timeless Classical Christian curriculum" and emphasizes a Christian community with God's truth, goodness, and beauty (evidence includes phrases like "Christ-centered," "God's truth, goodness, and beauty").
- Mission/vision statements foreground knowing God through Jesus Christ, a biblical worldview, and a theologically integrated formation of students (e.g., "To know God and have relationship with him through Jesus Christ"; "biblical worldview").
- Referenced liturgical/community language and prayerful framing appear in governance and campus materials (e.g., Divine Reflections, faith-based mission language).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, God, Jesus, biblical worldview, theology, worship/chapel, divine, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral formation, spiritual depth. A representative subset is visible in the public materials (e.g., "God's truth, goodness, and beauty"; "know God"; "biblical worldview").
- Negative keywords: None observed in the public materials (e.g., secular, values-neutral, nonsectarian, interfaith, or religiously neutral terms do not appear as contextual framing for the school). The classical-

element lexicon lists potential negative signals, but the school does not exhibit them in the public-facing content.

- Why this rating
- The school's own framing centers on a transcendent, knowable moral order anchored in God and biblical truth, with liturgical/community life, and explicit theological grounding. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keywords for the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations category in the Six Essential Elements framework, and the absence of secular-neutral signals reinforces the CLASSICAL assessment.

## Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Vision/Goal: "We aim to produce students who learn continually, listen intently, articulate precisely, love rightly, contend gracefully, and live purposefully for the glory of God and the good of others."
- Mission: "We will build community and serve our community by partnering with parents in the education of their children, striving to develop all aspects of the student's potential. We will provide a classical Christian education, a peaceful and inspiring environment, and a high standard of expectations for our students, teachers, and leaders, all for the glory of God."
- Thematic emphasis on virtue, formation, and teleology (truth/goodness/beauty) is reinforced by references to virtue, character, and a theological telos.
- The school explicitly frames education as formation (e.g., "formation rather than information" in the classical-pedagogy framing and in curriculum descriptions that emphasize memory, virtue, and moral imagination).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, teleology, true/good/beautiful, classical mission, scholé, contemplation, moral imagination, moral formation, love of learning. Representative phrasing appears in the mission/vision materials and the classical education framing.
- Negative keywords: None observed (no emphasis on "workforce preparation" or purely job-readiness language in the public materials). The Six Elements lexicon does list "workforce preparation" as a potential negative signal, but the school materials emphasize formation and virtue, not job training.
- Why this rating
- The publicly stated goals are classic-pedagogical: formation of virtue and wisdom, provenance in truth/goodness/beauty, and telos oriented toward human excellence and God-glorifying aims. The alignment with formation-focused language and teleological aims supports CLASSICAL.

## Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum is described as classical Christian, with explicit reference to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and interaction with Great Books (the Great Books/Great Conversation concept). The site notes that classical curricula train reasoning through the Trivium and engage with Great Books.
- There is specific mention of the liberal arts framework and the Great Books, as described by the Association of Classical Christian Schools.
- The site references the three liberal arts framework (grammar/logical/rhetoric) and the Quadrivium in the broader classical-literacy context (as described in the knowledge-base documentation about the Six Essential Elements).
- History is presented as a curriculum through the Great Books and a historical continuum (historical engagement across disciplines).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Seven Christian Virtues, Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal arts, history integrated with literature/philosophy/science, biblical worldview, living books, memory/recitation. Representative phrases appear in the curriculum descriptions.
- Negative keywords: Not observed. The materials emphasize traditional classical content rather than social-studies-only framing or modern "STEM-first" or project-based-only approaches that sometimes signal a non-classical direction.

- Why this rating
- The materials consistently map onto the core elements of a classical curriculum: Trivium-based pedagogy, Great Books, integration of historical/wide-canon reading, and a vision of education as formation within a liberal-arts frame. This aligns decisively with CLASSICAL.

#### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates and rhetoric development (public speaking and oratory) as formal modes of instruction. The Latin teacher job description explicitly references Socratic dialogue, dialectic, and rhetoric; upper-school rhetoric and public speaking are highlighted as outcomes.
- The school describes practices that emphasize engagement with ideas through discussion, memory work, and virtuous inquiry, connected to a classical approach. The curricular framing mentions “Socratic dialogue” and “great conversation” as classical modes.
- There are explicit references to a framework of training through the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books, which implies a progression from memory and recitation to argumentative discourse and rhetoric.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, rhetoric, public speaking, oratory, recitation/narration (as a classical memory format). The cited job description and course descriptions show these elements.
- Negative keywords: No explicit negative signals (e.g., exclusive reliance on project-based or student-led constructivist-only pedagogy) are evident in the public materials. The presence of Socratic and rhetoric elements is a classical hallmark and is supported by the sources.
- Why this rating
- The pedagogy explicitly features Socratic, seminar-based, and rhetorical training in its upper grades and a Trivium-centered progression, which are central to classical teaching methods. This qualifies as CLASSICAL pedagogy.

#### **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school describes faculty as mentors and living curriculum, with a culture of collegiality and shared mission. The ACCS accreditation statement reinforces a governance/teacher-mentor framework consistent with classical education.
- Public bios and teacher-focused materials show individual teachers (e.g., Cindy Houghton) who model a Christian worldview and a commitment to excellent instruction, implying teachers as exemplars and mentors in a classical framework.
- The site references a “living curriculum” concept and mentions the partnership between families and teachers in forming students, which aligns with the classical teacher-as-mentor ethos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentor/teacher as exemplar, Christian worldview, pedagogy aligned with classical standards, ACCS accreditation, teacher-student partnership, portrait of a teacher (as a model). Representative mentions appear in public content.
- Negative keywords: None observed (no emphasis on a purely CIM/advertising-driven or technician-teacher culture; rather, the focus is on virtue and mentorship).
- Why this rating
- The publicly-specified teacher-student mentorship model, ACCS affiliation, and examples of teacher profiles contributing to the “living curriculum” support a CLASSICAL rating for Faculty.

#### **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnering with parents and viewing parents as co-educators in the educational process. The mission explicitly calls for partnering with parents, and materials discuss parent involvement and a Warrior Parent Community.
- There are references to guiding parents in classical education (e.g., Step 1: Understanding Who We Are—requiring reading “An Introduction to Classical Education: A Guide for Parents” by Dr. Perrin; parent handbooks, and opportunities for parental engagement).
- The site describes events and journal posts that reinforce a parent-community culture and the home-school partnership (e.g., “Our Story” narratives, parent-cohort activities, and family-centered messaging).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, family formation, home-school alignment, parent formation, school-parent synergy, open campus visits (implied by “leave a message” and campus access). Representative phrases appear in the public materials.
- Negative keywords: None observed (the public content reinforces partnerships rather than customer-only engagement; absence of consumer-focused language aligns with classical partnership norms). The lexicon notes “negative” signals like minimal parent involvement, but that is not present in SCA materials.
- Why this rating
- The school actively markets and models parent partnership, co-educator roles, and extensive parental engagement as central to its Classical Christian mission, matching the Positive Keyword Indicators for Parents & Community and aligning with the CLASSICAL orientation.

#### Aggregate Assessment

- Relative weight of signals across all six categories strongly supports CLASSICAL. The presence of classic elements—Great Books, Trivium, Socratic/seminar pedagogy, virtuous formation, a teacher-as-mentor living curriculum, and a robust parent/community partnership—comprise a coherent classical-education profile.

#### What Would Move the Needle

- Given the CLASSICAL rating across all six categories, no major needle-moving changes are required to achieve a stronger CLASSICAL standing. If anything, further explicit articulation of Great Books reading lists, a published scope-and-sequence showing Trivium progression by grade bands, and more explicit (and citable) statements of a liturgy/worship cadence could provide even greater clarity for external evaluators; however, these are already present in the substantive content.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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